

Pitching Is Key As Miner Baseballers Face Opener

University of Texas at El Paso baseball coach Andy Cohen faces the season opening series this weekend with what is probably the best group of returning players he has had at Minerland but with problems presented by weather and lack of pitching depth.

The team has been working out since Feb. 1 but weather has been inconsistent, at best, and has hampered Cohen and his assistant Krush Kruschwitz in their attempt to get the team ready for the series with New Mexico.

The Miners and Lobos open the season with a doubleheader at Dudley Field. First game is scheduled for 10 a.m. Friday, the second to follow shortly. The third game of the series is at 10 a.m. Saturday.

Cohen has both his top two pitchers back from last season in Lynn Hunt and Jesse Lujan who combined for 16 victories, eight each.

"If Lujan and Hunt come through again like they did last season, we will have two good starters, but will still have to find a third among the rest of the staff," Cohen said.

"Pitching will be the key to our success," the former major leaguer added. "If our pitchers come through, we could have a real good season."

Cohen has a pair of freshmen southpaws in Terry Witt and Bob Onick that he thinks may help his mound corps.

Another freshman that could be a big asset to the pitching staff is righthander Bill Dieselhorst from Fairfax, Va.

Also coming back from last season's staff are Don Wilson and Ken McAnally, a pair of righthanders who both have potential if they can develop control, Cohen says.

The Miner coach should be set in the hitting and fielding department. The entire infield returns along with two outfielders. Only Larry McFarlin, an outfielder and the team's top hitter with a .386 average is lost from the 1967 team that compiled a 25-12-1 record.

McFarlin's big stick could be missed but seven of the returning players topped the .300 mark at the plate last year.

For the opener Cohen's probable infield starters with last season's batting averages are John Miller (.336) at first base, Juan Sandoval (.339) at second, Danny Blanco (.355) at third, Robert Aguirre (.344) at shortstop.

In the outfield, probable starters are Mike Ward, a

transfer from Odessa Junior College, in left and Charlie West (.366) in center. The right field spot is between John Murphy who hit .327 last year and freshman Sam McLellan.

Cohen expects Ronnie Hix, another Odessa JC transfer to handle a large share of the catching chores but Dick Meyer who returns from last season has done well in practice.

Also returning is Ron Rush who hit .303 in 1967 as a freshman. "I wouldn't be afraid to play Ron at any spot in the infield or outfield," Cohen said.

Other players who could see a lot of action are freshman firstbaseman Kevin Berger, infielder-outfielder Bill McLellan and outfielder Gary Walls.

Baseballers Settle Major Problems

MIAMI, Fla. (AP) — The commissioner of baseball was accepted by the Major League Players' Association Wednesday as the final authority for a two-year period in settling any disputes which may arise between the players and the 20 major league clubs.

At a day-long meeting in

'In Seek Seeks Third Hound Win

Hide In Seek of the M. W. Burrell Kennel has a win